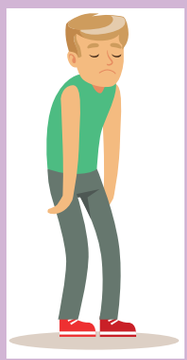
Key risk of Anaemia

- Impaired cognitive functioning and memory
- Decreased school performance
- Compromised growth and development
- Increased risk of pregnancy related complications
- Decreased work capacity
- Depressed immune function

Preventive measures

Adolescents should be encouraged to consume iron rich foods (green leafy vegetables, jaggery, meat) complemented with a Vitamin C source like Citrus fruits (oranges, lemon) and Indian gooseberry (Amla). Adolescent girls need additional requirement of Iron to compensate for menstrual blood loss





India is home to 243 million adolescents – children aged 10 to 19 years – the most adolescents of any country. Sadly, a large proportion of India's adolescents are anaemic: 56 per cent of girls and 30 per cent of boys.

Anaemia among adolescents adversely affects these young people's growth, resistance to infections, cognitive development and work productivity.

3.5.4 Eating disorders in adolescence

Anorexia Nervosa and Bulimia

Anorexia is described as a state of emaciation that has been brought on by voluntary starvation. It is seen primarily in adolescent girls from middle and upper class families where the victim refuses to eat. Anorectic adolescents usually experience amenorrhea and sometimes fatal electrolyte imbalances. They deny that they are emaciated, inspite of a skeleton like appearance and usually continue to pursue thinness by refusing to eat.



Another related phenomenon known as "gorge and purge" or Bulimia is seen among adolescent girls in socio economic backgrounds similar to those who develop anorexia nervosa. These individuals consume enormous quantities of food and then immediately induce vomiting or take laxatives to purge themselves of the food and thus the nutrients they provide.



3.5.5 Nutrition and the Menstrual Cycle

One of the many challenges girls face as they become women is the onset of menstruation. These hormones that regulate

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